

Google Docs

First off, “Docs” as mentioned above is not the result of Serious SMS Syndrome—the service is actually called “Google Docs,” and not “Google Documents”!

4.1 Introduction

As already explained in the previous chapter on Google Spreadsheets (GS), Google Docs (GD) is part of Google’s strategy to replace offline office applications with their online counterparts.

Besides the functionality of GS, in terms of creating, storing, importing, and exporting documents, GD offers a few additional features—like the ability to incorporate RSS feeds, the ability to track revisions, and the ability to publish a document to your blog. A major deficiency is the absence of an integrated IM client, which would probably be considered essential for collaborative projects.

GD is the result of Google’s acquisition of Upstartle, a company that created Writely—a Web-based word processor. After the acquisition, Writely was renamed “Google Docs.”

4.2 Using GD

4.2.1 Logging In

You need a Google or Gmail ID to be able to use GD. If you are a Gmail user, you can add the GD service from the “All my Services” link at the top left of the Gmail mailbox page. Signing in takes you to the Google Spreadsheets and Docs staging area. This area, as described in the previous chapter, is a place where a record of all the documents you have been working on is maintained. You can also see the status of each of the documents—